



Switching tactics: Head coach Amol Muzumdar saw Richa's potential beyond her finishing role, promoting her to number 3 in ODIs to play more impactful and long innings. PTI

Rodrigues and Meg Lanning came over to comfort her.

"You'll win the World Cup for us, Richa!" Jemimah was overheard telling her India teammate.

"Every player should experience something like that at some point in their career because there's so much to learn," Richa shares. "I'm glad I faced something like that so early. I was very hurt after that game because I couldn't finish it in our favour. All I wanted was to move on quickly and finish the next game properly. As a hitter, I like finishing matches, and that time, I couldn't."

A week later, against the same opponent at the same venue, Richa righted the wrongs, hitting the winning runs and leading RCB to its

first WPL title.

All these experiences, transformative or otherwise, have sharpened Richa's focus on glory in India colours. At just 20, she's already one of India's trump cards ahead of the Women's T20 World Cup in the United Arab Emirates — evidence of her immense talent and meteoric rise in what is one of the most competitive eras for the sport.

Learning on the job

When India played England and Australia last winter, head coach Amol Muzumdar, fresh in the role, saw the potential for Richa beyond her finishing capability. He envisioned her as a more versatile player and gave her the number 3 slot in ODIs, hoping she could build larger and more impactful innings.

"Essentially, I'm a finisher. I'll do

« International experiences, like her stints in WBBL and The Hundred, have been instrumental in Richa's growth »